05-25 第二篇

The Art of Saying No: Setting Healthy Boundaries

Many people find it hard to say "no." They agree to help friends, join activities, or take on extra work even when they are tired or busy. They worry about disappointing others or seeming rude. But saying "yes" to everything can leave you stressed, tired, and with no time for yourself. [1] In fact, saying "no" when you need to is not selfish—it is necessary. It protects your time, your energy, and your health. When you say "no" to things that do not fit your goals or values, you make room for what matters. That is why learning to say "no" is an important life skill. It helps you live a more balanced and honest life.

Why do we find it so hard to say "no"? [2] We often want to please others and avoid conflict. We fear that saying "no" will make people think we are unkind or lazy. Sometimes we worry about missing out if we refuse. But saying "no" does not mean you do not care—it means you are being honest about your limits. In other words, the difficulty comes from our worries, not from the word itself. With practice, we can learn to say "no" politely and firmly, without hurting relationships. The key is to be clear and respectful.

How can you say "no" in a good way? [3] Be honest but kind. You do not need to give long excuses—a simple "I cannot do that right now" or "That does not work for me" is enough. You can suggest an alternative: "I cannot help today, but I might be able to next week." Thank the person for thinking of you, and stay calm. For this reason, saying "no" well is a skill—it takes practice. The goal is to protect your boundaries while still showing respect. Most people will understand if you are clear and polite.

What happens when you learn to say "no"? [4] You have more time and energy for the things that matter to you. You feel less stressed and more in control. Your relationships can improve because you are honest instead of resentful（怨恨的）. It is true that saying "no" gets easier with practice. At first it may feel uncomfortable, but over time you will feel freer and more confident. You will discover that the right people respect your boundaries—and those who do not may not be worth pleasing.

[5] In short, saying "no" is a way to respect yourself and others. It is not about being negative—it is about being honest. When you set clear boundaries, you protect your well-being and build healthier relationships. Remember: you cannot pour from an empty cup. If you are always saying "yes" to others, you will have nothing left for yourself. So the next time you want to say "no," give yourself permission—it is one of the kindest things you can do for yourself and for those who truly matter.

选项

A. That is because saying "no" when needed protects your well-being. B. In other words, our fear of disappointing others makes "no" hard to say. C. That is why saying "no" well is a skill that improves with practice. D. It is true that saying "no" gets easier with practice. E. In conclusion, saying "no" is a form of self-respect and honesty. F. For example, some people say "no" by offering to help another time.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：总领说"不"的必要性与价值。空前描述"Many people find it hard to say 'no'...But saying 'yes' to everything can leave you stressed, tired, and with no time for yourself"，空后说明"In fact, saying 'no' when you need to is not selfish—it is necessary...It protects your time, your energy, and your health...When you say 'no' to things that do not fit your goals or values, you make room for what matters...learning to say 'no' is an important life skill"。A选项"That is because saying 'no' when needed protects your well-being"（那是因为在需要时说"不"能保护你的身心健康）中"That is because"解释说"不"的价值，"protects your well-being"与空后protects your time/energy/health、balanced life精准对应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：难以说"不"的心理原因。空前设问"Why do we find it so hard to say 'no'?"，空后列举"We often want to please others and avoid conflict...We fear that saying 'no' will make people think we are unkind or lazy...Sometimes we worry about missing out if we refuse...the difficulty comes from our worries, not from the word itself...With practice, we can learn to say 'no' politely and firmly"。B选项"In other words, our fear of disappointing others makes 'no' hard to say"（换言之，我们害怕让别人失望，所以很难说"不"）中"In other words"概括空后内容，"fear of disappointing others"与空后please others、fear、worry about missing out完美呼应，衔接自然。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：如何得体地说"不"——技巧与练习。空前设问"How can you say 'no' in a good way?"，空后详述"Be honest but kind...You do not need to give long excuses...You can suggest an alternative...Thank the person for thinking of you, and stay calm...saying 'no' well is a skill—it takes practice...The goal is to protect your boundaries while still showing respect"。C选项"That is why saying 'no' well is a skill that improves with practice"（因此得体地说"不"是一门

随练习而提升的技能）中"That is why"承接空前及空后结论，"skill that improves with practice"与空后takes practice、be clear and polite精准对应，逻辑紧密。

- [4] D：
  - **线索**：学会说"不"后的积极变化与熟能生巧。空前设问"What happens when you learn to say 'no'?"，空后说明"You have more time and energy for the things that matter...You feel less stressed and more in control...Your relationships can improve...saying 'no' gets easier with practice...At first it may feel uncomfortable, but over time you will feel freer and more confident...the right people respect your boundaries"。D选项"It is true that saying 'no' gets easier with practice"（的确，说"不"会随着练习而变得更容易）中"It is true that"加强衔接，"gets easier with practice"与空后saying 'no' gets easier with practice、over time you will feel freer完美呼应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：全文收束与说"不"作为自我尊重。空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后总结"saying 'no' is a way to respect yourself and others...It is not about being negative—it is about being honest...When you set clear boundaries, you protect your well-being and build healthier relationships...you cannot pour from an empty cup...give yourself permission—it is one of the kindest things you can do for yourself"。E选项"In conclusion, saying 'no' is a form of self-respect and honesty"（总之，说"不"是一种自尊与诚实的表现）用"In conclusion"总结全文，"self-respect and honesty"与空后respect yourself、being honest、protect your well-being形成呼应，收束有力。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some people say "no" by offering to help another time.**：涉及通过"改天再帮"委婉拒绝，易被误填[3]。但F讨论的是具体话术举例，而空[3]概括如何得体地说"不"的整体原则与技巧（honest but kind、suggest alternative、thank the person）；F属于策略细节，空[3]已用"You can suggest an alternative"涵盖此类做法，且空[3]更侧重"skill"与"practice"，F的论述层级偏窄。F属"主题相关但论述层级错位"型干扰。